Research methodology - Reviewing papers

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Peer review

Based on
- COPE Ethical Guidelines for Peer Reviewers (https://publicationethics.org/files/cope-ethical-guidelines-peer-reviewers-v2_0.pdf)
- Understanding science (https://undsci.berkeley.edu/understanding-science-101/how-science-works/scrutinizing-science-peer-review/),
- Napolitani-Petrini-Garattini: Ethics of reviewing scientific publications
- Kelly et al.: Peer Review in Scientific Publications: Benefits, Critiques, & A Survival Guide

Peer review

- Peer scholars read and comment papers submitted for publication;
- Assures, that published research meets scientific quality;
- Trusted form of scientific communication;
- Outcome: feedback (errors, corrections, improvements) to the authors and
- Recommendation to editors/Programme Committee, ...;
- Revision and resubmisson;
- Acception rate;
- Requirements: transparency, responsibility, accuracy, ethics;

Review processes

Timing	Preprints	Pre-publication	Post-publication
Identifiability	Double blind	Single blind	Open
Mediation	Editors mediate all interactions between reviewers and authors	Reviewers interact with one another openly	Reviewers and authors all interact with one another openly
Publication	Peer reviews are not published	Peer reviews are published but not signed	Peer reviews are published and signed
Facilitation	Review facilitated by a journal	Review facilitated by a third party	Review facilitated by authors
Ownership	Review owned by a journal or third party	Review owned by the authors of the reviews	Shared or mixed ownership of reviews

Review forms - example

- Recommendation: strong reject, reject, weak reject, borderline, weak accept, accept, strong accept (-3 .. 3);
- Summary of the content and Evaluation of
  - Technical Content and Accuracy (1 - 7): 5
  - Significance of the Work (1 - 7): 4
  - Appropriate Title, Introduction, and Conclusion (1 - 7): 6
  - Overall Organization (1 - 7): 6
  - Appropriateness for the conf/journal (1 - 7): 6
  - Style and Clarity of the Paper (1 - 7): 5
  - Originality of Content (1 - 7): 3
- Novelty of results: beyond state of the art (related work)?
- Appropriateness of the methods, validation, references;
- Comments on errors, typos, grammar, figures;
- Proposal for improvements;
- Reviewers confidence and Confidential remarks;

Ethical issues

- Commitment to voluntary reviewing;
- Conflict of interest between reviewer/subreviewer and author
  - Same institute;
  - Result of joint research project;
  - Relatives;
- Reviewer (PC member) is responsible for subreviewer;
- for Confidentality of unpublished results;
- for Checking for plagiarism and violation of guidelines;
- be professional, pleasant, helpful, scientific, timely, realistic, respectful,

Paper bidding and assignment

In the table below the assigned papers are marked by "*"

I prefer not to review it
I want to review this paper
I can review it
I have a conflict of interest

	A	A	C	C	C	D	D	E	G	H	H	H	H	K	K	L	L	N	N	N	O	P	P	T	T	T	T	V	Z	
2																				*	*								*	3
3											*						*											*		3
4								*																	*	*				3
5	*								*											*										3
6									*	*					*															3
7			*										*														*			3
9													*								*						*			3
10				*		*																				*				3
11																*		*						*						3
12	*																*				*								*	4
13								*			*	*					*													4
14						*				*																		*		3
15													*	*													*			3
17											*				*			*												3
18																*									*	*				3
19		*														*								*						3
20						*							*						*				*				*			5
21								*				*						*	*											4
22	*																		*										*	3
23		*					*							*																3
25		*																						*	*					3
26				*			*													*										3

Review status

Several reviews, remarks and discussion.

Scores	Average	Decision
2(4),**3**(4),**2**(3)	2.3	ACCEPT
2(3),**3**(3),**1**(4)	2.0	ACCEPT
2(4),**2**(4),**2**(3)	2.0	ACCEPT
3(4),**2**(4),**0**(4)	1.7	ACCEPT
2(3),**2**(4),**0**(3)	1.3	ACCEPT
1(4),**1**(3),**1**(4)	1.0	ACCEPT
2(4),**2**(4),**-1**(4)	1.0	ACCEPT
1(3),**1**(3),**1**(4)	1.0	ACCEPT
1(4),**2**(4),**2**(5),**-2**(4)	0.8	ACCEPT
2(3),**0**(4),**0**(3)	0.7	ACCEPT
2(3),**-1**(4),**1**(4),**0**(4),**1**(4)	0.6	ACCEPT
1(3),**0**(4),**0**(3)	0.3	REJECT
2(4),**0**(4),**-2**(4),**1**(4)	0.2	ACCEPT
2(3),**2**(4),**-2**(5),**-1**(4)	0.2	ACCEPT
-1(5),**-1**(3),**2**(3)	0.0	REJECT
-1(5),**-2**(4),**-1**(5),**2**(4)	-0.5	REJECT
0(4),**-2**(5),**0**(4)	-0.7	REJECT
0(4),**-1**(4),**-1**(4)	-0.7	REJECT
-1(3),**0**(4),**-2**(4)	-1.0	REJECT
-3(5),**-1**(4),**0**(4)	-1.3	REJECT
-3(4),**1**(4),**-2**(4)	-1.3	REJECT
-2(4),**0**(4),**-2**(4)	-1.3	REJECT
-2(4),**-2**(3),**-2**(4)	-2.0	REJECT

Where to publish

- Journals: D1, Q1, Q2, etc. (SJR, Scimago Journal Ranking - based on weighted citations of other journals);
- Conferences: A* (flagship, 7.24%), A (excellent), B (good), etc. (https://www.core.edu.au/conference-portal);
- Reputable Open access (https://doaj.org) and predator open access journals/conferences (fake editors, reviewers);
- Average review and publishging time of journals, draft proceedings, proceedings, post-proceedings;
- Free open access archive: https://arxiv.org/corr (not peer-reviewed, but moderation process - Cornell Tech);
- Talk to librarian;